

HS110 | Introduction to Psychology

Practice Question Paper — Set 3

Total Marks: 50 | Time: 2 Hours Full Syllabus

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (20 Marks)

Each question carries 1 mark. Choose the most appropriate option.

1. Which of the following statements best explains why psychology is NOT considered "common sense"?
 - (a) Psychology uses complex language
 - (b) Psychology focuses on empirical, systematic, and intersubjective evidence ♦
 - (c) Common sense is always wrong
 - (d) Psychology only studies abnormal behaviour
2. Structuralism, founded by Wundt, asked the question:
 - (a) "How do mental processes help us adapt?"
 - (b) "What is the structure of the mind?" ♦
 - (c) "What drives human potential and growth?"
 - (d) "How do biological systems affect behaviour?"
3. Which field of psychology focuses on optimising athletic performance and psychological well-being in sports?
 - (a) Health Psychology
 - (b) Forensic Psychology
 - (c) Sports Psychology ♦
 - (d) Educational Psychology
4. A researcher studies the same group of IIT Bombay students from their first year to their fourth year, collecting data annually. This is:
 - (a) Cross-sectional research
 - (b) Experimental research
 - (c) Longitudinal research ♦
 - (d) Correlational research
5. A correlation coefficient of **-0.88** indicates:
 - (a) A weak negative relationship
 - (b) A strong positive relationship
 - (c) A strong negative relationship ♦
 - (d) No meaningful relationship
6. The tendency of an experimenter's expectations to unintentionally influence study results is called:
 - (a) Courtesy bias
 - (b) Experimenter effect ♦
 - (c) Observer bias
 - (d) Reporting bias

7. Which part of the brain plays a critical role in fear responses and is the first to receive sensory information enabling quick reactions to danger?
- (a) Hippocampus
 - (b) Cingulate cortex
 - (c) Amygdala ♦
 - (d) Hypothalamus
8. Huntington's disease, which involves the decay of brain nerve cells over time, is linked to dysfunction in the:
- (a) Medulla oblongata
 - (b) Cerebellum
 - (c) Basal ganglia ♦
 - (d) Pons
9. The somatic nervous system controls:
- (a) Involuntary internal organ functions
 - (b) The fight-or-flight response
 - (c) Voluntary muscle movements ♦
 - (d) Hormone regulation
10. Which type of learning does NOT require direct experience or reinforcement?
- (a) Classical conditioning
 - (b) Operant conditioning
 - (c) Observational learning ♦
 - (d) Drive-reduction learning
11. A student who is scolded every time they talk during lectures and eventually stops talking is experiencing:
- (a) Positive reinforcement
 - (b) Negative reinforcement
 - (c) Punishment by application ♦
 - (d) Punishment by removal
12. The **Law of Effect** (Thorndike) states that:
- (a) Behaviour followed by a pleasant consequence tends to be repeated ♦
 - (b) Neutral stimuli become conditioned through repeated pairing
 - (c) People learn best by watching role models
 - (d) Behaviour is driven by biological instincts
13. The **Serial Position Effect** in memory refers to:
- (a) Citing information from memory
 - (b) Remembering information from memory
 - (c) Remembering information from memory
 - (d) Remembering information from memory

- (a) Chunking information to increase STM capacity
- (b) Better recall for items at the beginning and end of a list ♦
- (c) Interference caused by similar-sounding words
- (d) Failure to encode information due to distraction

14. The memory system that stores knowledge of word meanings, facts, and concepts is:

- (a) Episodic memory
- (b) Procedural memory
- (c) Semantic memory ♦
- (d) Iconic memory

15. Raven's Progressive Matrices is considered a culture-fair test because it:

- (a) Tests verbal and numerical ability
- (b) Uses non-verbal pattern recognition that minimises language/cultural bias ♦
- (c) Was developed across multiple countries simultaneously
- (d) Tests only fluid intelligence in children

16. Thurstone's **Space (S)** primary mental ability would be most relevant for which profession?

- (a) Librarian
- (b) Stand-up comedian
- (c) Aerospace engineer ♦
- (d) Medical doctor diagnosing illnesses

17. Gardner's intelligence that involves deep self-reflection and awareness of one's own emotions is:

- (a) Interpersonal intelligence
- (b) Intrapersonal intelligence ♦
- (c) Existential intelligence
- (d) Naturalistic intelligence

18. The hormone that stimulates eating by signalling the lateral hypothalamus when insulin rises is regulated by:

- (a) Leptin
- (b) Ventromedial hypothalamus
- (c) Lateral hypothalamus ♦
- (d) Epinephrine

19. According to McClelland, a person who strongly desires social interaction, friendships, and being liked by others has a high:

- (a) Need for achievement
- (b) Need for power

- (b) Need for power
- (c) Need for affiliation ♦
- (d) Need for self-actualisation

20. Display rules in emotional expression refer to:

- (a) The physiological changes that accompany strong emotions
- (b) Learned ways of controlling emotional displays in social settings ♦
- (c) Universal facial expressions that all humans share
- (d) The cognitive labelling of emotions based on context

SECTION B — True/False and Match the Following (10 Marks)

Part I — True or False (1 mark each, 5 marks)

1. Informed consent and the right to withdraw are key ethical principles in psychological research. **[True]**
2. Smell is the only sense that does not pass through the thalamus before reaching the brain. **[True]**
3. Stimulus discrimination means responding to stimuli *similar* to the original conditioned stimulus. **[False]**
4. In Maslow's theory, esteem needs are classified as growth needs. **[False]**
5. The recency effect occurs because the last items on a list are still held in short-term memory. **[True]**

Part II — Match the Following (1 mark each, 5 marks)

Column A	Column B
1. Observational learning	(a) Reinforcement tied to unpredictable time intervals
2. Variable interval schedule	(b) Information never encoded into long-term memory
3. Encoding failure	(c) Attention, Memory, Imitation, Desire
4. Anorexia nervosa	(d) Severe refusal to eat; skeletal appearance
5. Extrinsic motivation	(e) Performing action for external outcomes/rewards

Answers: 1-c, 2-a, 3-b, 4-d, 5-e

SECTION C — Answer in One Word / Term (10 Marks)

Each answer carries 1 mark.

1. The type of descriptive research that studies one individual in great depth (e.g., Phineas Gage). (*Clinical case study*)
 2. The phenomenon where a participant behaves differently simply because they know they are being observed. (*Observer effect / Hawthorne effect*)
 3. Neurons that carry messages from the spinal cord or brain outward to muscles and glands. (*Efferent / Motor neurons*)
 4. The schedule of reinforcement that leads to the highest resistance to extinction (e.g., slot machines). (*Variable ratio*)
 5. The type of memory loss where new declarative long-term memories cannot be formed after a trauma. (*Anterograde amnesia*)
 6. The memory aid that helps recall by connecting new information to already-known material. (*Mnemonic*)
 7. Binet's measure comparing a child's intellectual performance to their actual age. (*Mental Age*)
 8. Sternberg's ability to deal with new concepts and find novel solutions — associated with divergent thinking. (*Creative intelligence*)
 9. The biological drive theory's term for the body's tendency to maintain internal equilibrium. (*Homeostasis*)
 10. The emotional theory that focuses on the thalamus and states that both the physiological response and the emotional feeling occur at the same time. (*Cannon-Bard Theory*)
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SECTION D — Answer in Brief (10 Marks)

Answer ANY 2 of the following 3 questions. Each carries 5 marks.

Q1. Explain **neuroplasticity** and its three types (experience-dependent, developmental, and injury-induced). Why is neuroplasticity clinically significant? Give one applied example.

Q2. With reference to the **theories of intelligence**, compare Spearman's Two-Factor Theory, Gardner's Multiple Intelligences, and Sternberg's Triarchic Theory. What is one shared criticism across these theories?

Q3. What are **emotions**? Describe the three components of emotion (physiological, cognitive, and behavioural). How do **universal emotions** and **display rules** demonstrate both the universal and cultural aspects of emotional expression?

— *End of Paper 3* —